

"We Are Happy to Have Jehovah as Our God"

Treasures From God's Word — 10 minutes | Isaiah 56-57

Week of April 27 – May 3, 2026

Introduction (~1 min)

(warm, conversational) Have you ever watched someone try to sit on a beach chair right at the water's edge?

(humor) They get settled, drink in hand, eyes closed... and then a wave knocks the chair sideways. They scoot back. Settle in again. Another wave. Sand everywhere. Drink gone.

(thoughtful pause) That picture — someone who just cannot find rest no matter how they reposition themselves — is exactly the picture Jehovah paints in Isaiah chapter 57. Today we'll see why being on Jehovah's side isn't just the *right* place to be — it's the only place where we can actually rest.

We'll consider three reasons we are happy to have Jehovah as our God.

Point 1: Idol worshippers who cry out for help are not heard (~2.5 min)

(read with conviction) Please open your Bibles to **Isaiah 57:13**. *(slow delivery)*

"When you cry for help, your collection of idols will not rescue you. A wind will carry all of them away..."

(pause) Notice the contrast Jehovah draws. People had built up a whole *collection* of idols — they invested time, money, hope. But when trouble came and they cried out, the idols were so weightless that a *breeze* carried them off.

(reflective) The Isaiah's Prophecy book (**ip-2** p. 269 ¶14) helps us see this isn't just about ancient statues. Anything we trust to rescue us *instead* of Jehovah is an idol. Career security. A bank balance. Even our own cleverness.

(humor, lighter tone) Some of us put more faith in our morning coffee than in prayer — and brothers, I include myself in that.

(warm) But here's the beautiful thing — Jehovah never has to be carried by the wind. *(slow)* He IS the One who *sends* the wind.

How does this draw us closer to Him? When we feel that pull to lean on something visible, something we can hold — that's the moment to pause and cry out to Jehovah instead. Every time we do, we strengthen the bond.

Point 2: People without Jehovah are restless and divided (~2.5 min)

(read steadily) **Isaiah 57:20:**

"But the wicked are like the restless sea that cannot calm down, and its waters keep tossing up seaweed and mire."

(*illustrative, vivid*) Have you ever stood at the shore after a storm? The water isn't beautiful blue — it's churning brown, throwing up tangled weeds, dead fish, old plastic bottles. (*pause*) That's the picture Jehovah uses for a life without Him. Not just *unhappy* — but constantly bringing the worst things back to the surface.

The Insight book under "Earth" (¶21) and the June 2018 *Watchtower* (w18.06 p. 7 ¶16) point out that this restlessness is *why* the world feels so divided today. People without Jehovah aren't just personally restless — they pull others into the churn with them.

(*personal, gentle*) Think about your most peaceful moments this week. (*pause*) Was it scrolling the news? (*humor*) I'm guessing not. It was probably reading a scripture, singing a Kingdom song, talking with a brother or sister. Jehovah's people aren't a stagnant pond — but we're not a tossing sea either. We're like a steady river — *moving*, but with direction.

How does this draw us closer to Him? Every time we choose Jehovah's calm over the world's churn — by what we watch, who we associate with, how we spend a Saturday morning — we are choosing the shore over the storm.

Point 3: There is no peace for the wicked (~2.5 min)

(*read with weight*) **Isaiah 57:21:**

"'There is no peace,' says my God, 'for the wicked.'"

(*slow, deliberate*) Eight words. No exceptions. No fine print.

The Insight book under "Peace" (¶3) explains that the Hebrew word for peace — *shalom* — doesn't just mean *absence of conflict*. It means **completeness, wholeness, soundness, welfare**. (*emphasize*) It's the feeling you get biting into perfectly ripe fruit — nothing missing, nothing extra. (*humor*) Not the sad grocery-store peach that looks great and tastes like wet cardboard. (*pause*) I mean a peach that *tastes* like a peach.

(*warm*) That's the kind of peace Jehovah offers — not artificial, not partial, but *complete*.

How does this draw us closer to Him? When we ask ourselves Jehovah's question — "*How does a good relationship with Jehovah make my life better?*" — the answer isn't just "I avoid bad things." The answer is, "I get to taste real *shalom* — wholeness — that no one outside the truth even knows exists."

Conclusion (~1 min)

(*sincere, building*) So picture again that person on the beach chair, getting battered by waves. (*pause*) Now picture someone else — sitting back from the shore, on solid ground, watching the same sea, completely at rest.

(*slow delivery*) Same world. Same waves. Different relationship with the One who made the sea.

(warm, conclude) Brothers and sisters — we are the ones on solid ground. And that is why we can say, with our whole heart: **we are happy to have Jehovah as our God.**

Delivery notes

- Total: ~9.5 min spoken, leaving 30 sec buffer
- Three scripture readings $\approx$ 45 sec total
- Two humor beats (coffee, peach) — keep light, don't oversell
- Two nature illustrations (beach chair frame, ripe fruit) bookend the talk